

RICHARD WAGNER

Quarter Centenary Celebration.

— 1905 —



PARSIFAL

Melbourne Liedertafel.

CONCERT

CHOIR AND ORCHESTRA
OF 350 PERFORMERS.

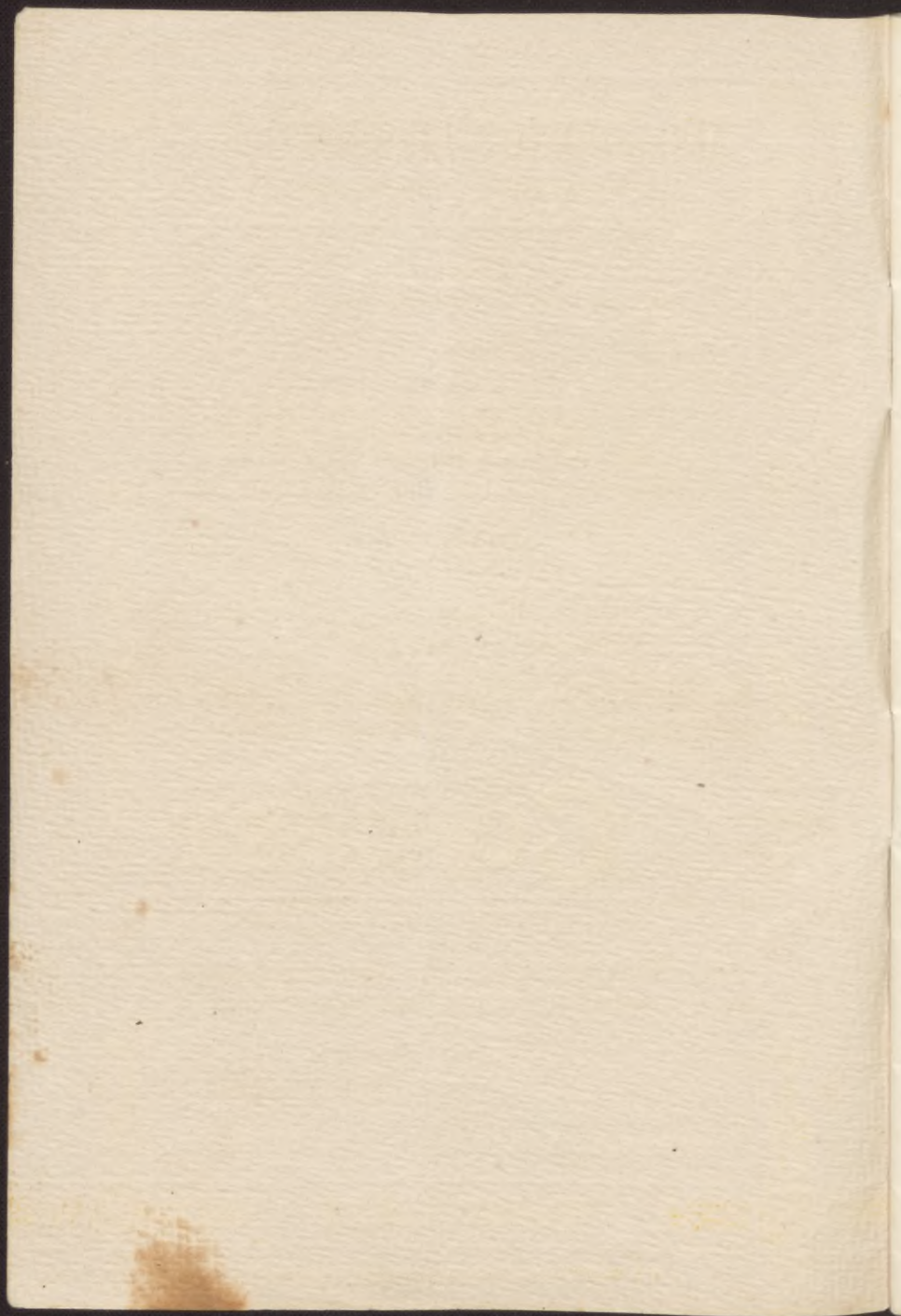
TOWN HALL,
SATURDAY, NOV. 18, 1893.

AT
3 O'CLOCK.

JOHANNES BRAHMS

EDWARD CRIGG

FRANZ LISZT



MELBOURNE LIEDERTAFEL.

INSTITUTED 1868.

RE-CONSTITUTED 1879.

Patron:

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The Orchestra.

CONDUCTOR - MR. HENRY JOHN KING.
PRINCIPAL VIOLIN MR. GEO. WESTON.

Violini Itri.—

Mr. G. Weston.
" F. Dierich.
" G. Sutch.
" E. King.
" H. Schraeder.
" B. Stevens.
" T. Zeplin.
" W. Josephi.

Violini IItri.—

Mr. J. Wright.
" M. A. Phillips.
" A. Zelman.
" E. Rawlins.
" H. Weinberg, senr.

Violi.—

Mr. G. H. Schacht.
" A. Zeplin.
" H. Edwards.
" T. Weidermann.

Violoncelli.—

Mr. Geo. E. Howard.
" F. Clutsam.
" C. Harrison.

Contra Bassi.—

Mr. A. Ceschina
" W. Brown.
" H. West.

Flauti.—

Mr. H. L. Stoneham.
" J. S. Smith.

Flauto Piccolo.—

Mr. G. Wright.

Oboi.—

Mr. E. Lyons.
" R. Carolane.
" T. Cuttle.

Cor Anglais.—

Mr. F. Luttich.

Clarinetti.—

Mr. Campbell.
" M. Lyons.
" J. B. Walters.

Fagotti.—

Mr. Moffitt.
" Chas. S. Rudall.
" A. N. Ingramells.

Corni.—

Mr. H. Kühr,
" A. Flewin.
" R. Peckotsch.
" W. H. Heathcote.

Trombe.—

Mr. H. Stoneham.
" T. Wilson.
" W. H. Matthias.

Tromboni.—

Mr. P. Downs.
" T. Lawson.
" S. Hore.

Tuba.—

Mr. J. Fries.

Timpani.—

Mr. J. Mumyard.
" T. J. Lamble.

Tamburo Piccolo.—

Mr. G. W. Corbett.

Cymbals } — *Campanetta* }

Mr. A. S. Clay.

Triangle and { — *Glocken* }

* Members of the Choir. *

FIRST TENOR.

Dickins, J. J. (Capt.)
Speed, R. D. (on leave)
Thomas, T. H.
Altmann, H.
Altmann, H. A.
Manson, D. E.
Dyer, J.
Hardy, J. W.
Heymansson, A. A.
Madden, D. A.

Beaumont, D. A.
Newman, F. A.
Robie, D. L.
Robinson, H. J. (on lve.)
Woess, Carl
Thackeray, J.
Heron, G. K.
Bird, Jno.

Ward, H.
Fletcher, S. H. (on leave)
Brunton, W.
Fullagher, A. G.
Eville, P. M.
Harley, G.
Donaldson, J. P.
Boosey, H.
Harvey, H. J.
Power, P.

SECOND TENOR.

Carne, A. E. (Capt.)
Rament, E.
Champion, W.
Forsyth, J. A.
Herring, W. E.
Lloyd, F.
Marshall, Capt. T. S. (on l.)
Hall, C. N.
Rundell, W. R.

Gray, Thos.
Whipp, A. A. (on leave)
Beere, R. H.
Morgan, C. W. (on leave)
Ford, H.
Hotchin, T. H. K.
Pleasants, E. A.
Bates, Chas. Junr.
McRae, H.

Friedhard, J. J.
Waugh, R. (on leave)
Wood, W. C.
Champion, J.
Ramsay, T. G.
Sprod, W. G. R.
Williams, E. H.
Williams, J. R.

FIRST BASS.

Day, G. A. (Capt.)
Bennett, J. J.
Clinton, F.
Garrity, W.
Garrett, H. (on leave)
Gerson, J.
Heathcote, W. H.
Henne, D.
Templeton, Capt. T. H.
Whitehead, F. S.
Hedding, Jas.
Carter, E. J.

Eddy, A. E.
Flood, W. H.
Bishop, A. A.
Küster, G. H.
Wilson, E. L.
Lennon, Geo. A.
Muirhead, G. H.
Turner, J. T.
Page, B.
Wilcox, W.
Excell, Fredk.
Pineus, S.

Heathershaw, S. A.
Farr, Leigh
Lemon, G. H.
Blades, R.
Hall, F. F.
Hislop, H. (on leave)
Smith, H. W.
Appleby, W. E.
Holtz, F.
Fleissner L.
Hall, C. E.

SECOND BASS.

Casper, E. (Capt.)
Berry, A.
Blashki, G. L.
Hasell, A. H.
Wilkes, K. (on leave)
McCall, R. W. V.
Pick, Geo.
Ashe, H. M.
Watson, Jno.
Griffith, H. L.
Statters, J.
Whitehead, A. E.

Turner, J. P.
Groube, H.
Pepper, F.
Wilmott, H. G.
Jones, W. C.
Adcock, John
Lewis, F.
Owen, E. T.
Smith, E. O.
Hearn, A. H.
Mattingly, A.

White, Thos. E.
Nunweek, A.
Sutherland, J.
Watkin, E. J. (on leave)
McHenry, E.
Williamson, W. T. B.
Smith, W.
Irving, H. A. C.
Lloyd, H. D.
Adelt, Louis

ASSOCIATED LADIES' CHOIR AND VOLUNTEERS.

The Liedertafel will be assisted by
the following Artists, who have
volunteered their services:

MDME. ELISE WIEDERMANN,

MISS ADA GROSSLEY,

MISS DORA STAMP

(Sole Pianoforte).

HERR RUDOLPH HIMMER,

HERR R. NITSCHKE

(Of Adelaide),

HERR ERNEST HARTUNG,

AND

HERR LOUIS FLEISSNER.

MELBOURNE LIEDERTAFEL.

ANNOUNCEMENTS.—The Council has to express its deep regret, that, owing to the continued ill health of Herr Julius Siede (the Society's Life Conductor), it will not be possible to carry out the promise made that he would conduct part of the "Scheme" this afternoon.

The Liedertafel—and the musical public generally—is indebted to MR. H. J. KING, the Conductor, for the whole of the music set down for performance this afternoon.

— THE — SCHEME. —

PARSIFAL

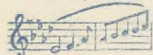
A Festival Drama

By RICHARD WAGNER.

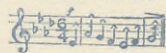


WAGNER was sixty-five years old when he began the music of "Parsifal"—the poem of which he had published in 1877. This Festival Drama occupied him until April 1879, while the instrumentation was finished at Palermo, January 13th, 1882. "Parsifal" was first produced in July 1882. Wagner has certainly in "Parsifal" succeeded in giving the most exquisite expressions to the deepest religious feeling—for Parsifal is really an allegorical personation of Christ—and, if we consider religious feeling the most exalted of all emotions, we must agree that Wagner in "Parsifal" struck finer chords than in any other of his works. The *Vorspiel* is based on

three of the most deeply religious motives in the entire work. It opens with the *Motive of the Sacrament*. Through this motive we gain insight into the office of the Knights of the Grail, who from time to time strengthen themselves for their spiritual duties by partaking of the Communion, on which occasions



the Grail itself is uncovered, the *Second Motive* is indicative of the Grail, and the trumpets announce the third—the *Motive of Faith*.



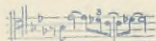
The plot of "Parsifal" is briefly as follows:—*Amfortas*, as King of the Knights of the Holy Grail, who dwell in the castle of Montsalvat among the mountains of Gothic Spain, is enticed by *Kundry*, a lovely woman under the sway of *Klingsor*, an evil magician on the southern slope of the same mountains, supposed to be facing Arabian Spain, into *Klingsor's* magic garden. While in her arms *Amfortas* drops the holy spear, which is at once seized by *Klingsor*, who wounds the King therewith, and carries it off. *Amfortas* cannot recover from the wound until it has been touched by the spear, which can be wrested from *Klingsor* only by "the guileless fool," one who has been all his life ignorant of sin, who through deep sympathy with the anguish of *Amfortas* becomes conscious of the King's sin, and can resist temptation though it come to him ever so enticingly. Such an one is *Parsifal*. By resisting *Kundry's* charms he regains the spear, destroys *Klingsor*, and thus frees *Kundry* from his evil sway, heals the wound of *Amfortas*, and is proclaimed King of the Knighthood. The plot is allegorical. *Parsifal* is the personification of Christianity, and the triumph of *Parsifal* over *Klingsor* is the triumph of Christianity over Paganism.

The performance this afternoon will—after the Vorspiel—begin at a point in Act I, where the Knights of the Grail are to celebrate the Love Feast or Communion that day. Gurnemanz—an old but vigorous knight—bids the youthful Parsifal accompany him to the castle. Then occurs a change of scene which in itself is highly effective dramatically. Long sustained trombone notes softly swell: approaching peals of bells are heard. At last Gurnemanz and Parsifal arrive at a mighty hall, which loses itself overhead in a high vaulted dome, down from which alone the light streams in. The change of

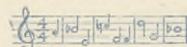


scene is ushered in by the solemn BELL MOTIVE, which is the basis of the powerful Orchestral Interlude accompanying the Panorama, and also of the scene in the hall of the Grail Castle. King Amfortas gives way to violent grief and the MOTIVE OF CONTRITION graphically

portrays his spiritual suffering. The MOTIVE OF THE SACRAMENT (followed by the BELL MOTIVE and the sonorous and powerful GRAIL MOTIVE) is



succeeded by the Knights intoning the chorus, "To the last love feast," while the Orchestra plays a solemn processional based on the Bell Motive. Amfortas is borne in preceded by pages who bear the covered Grail. A chorus based upon the Motive of Contrition and then the Motive of Faith floats down from the dome in ethereal beauty as if sung by angel voices. Tortured by contrition the King refuses Titurel's summons to uncover the Grail. Comforting voices chant the prophecy of Amfortas' redemption through the Guileless Fool. The Grail is uncovered and the voices chant the chorus, "Take of my body, take of my blood," to the Sacrament Motive. Amfortas is bowed in prayer. Through the dusk a ray of brilliant light darts upon the Grail; Amfortas raises the Grail and blesses the wine and bread, all kneeling, while voices in the dome chant a chorus based on the Sacrament Motive. When it has been repeated, one-half of the Knights intone a chant, the Bell Motive solemnly accompanying it in the Orchestra, the other half chorus repeats the chant, and then the entire chorus takes up the Grail Motive. To the Faith Motive the congregation prepares to go. Amfortas bows his head and touches his wound, his action being accompanied by the Motive of Contrition in unison with the Bell Motive. Parsifal presses his hand to his heart. We again hear the



Motive.

Motive of the Prophecy The Grail and Bell Motives lead once more to the Prophecy, and the Act closes amid the spiritual harmonies of the Prophecy of the Guileless Fool and of the Grail

Richard Wagner was born May 22, 1813, and died February 13, 1883.

—From *Gustav Kobbe* on "Wagner."

- A. Vorspiel for Orchestra alone.
- B. Verwandlungs — Musik und Schluss-Szene des 1ten Aktes.

First production in Australia of the latter.

PARSIFAL	-	HERR HIMMER.
GURNEMANZ	-	HERR ERNEST HARTUNG.
TITUREL	-	HERR LOUIS FLEISSNER.

The Knightly Brotherhood of the Grail, &c.

ASSOCIATED LADIES' CHOIR,
THE LIEDERTAFEL,
AND ORCHESTRA.

Gurnemanz—

From bathing comes the king again,
High stands the sun now :
So let me to the holy feast conduct thee,
For, an thou'st pure :
The Grail will surely feed and refresh thee.

Parsifal—

What is the Grail ?

Gurnem.—

I may not say ;
But if to serve it thou art bidden,
Knowledge of it will not be hidden.
And lo ! methinks I know thee now indeed,
No earthly road to it doth lead ;
By no one can it be detected,
Who by itself is not elected.

Parsifal—

I scarcely move, yet swiftly seem to run.

Gurnem.—

My son, thou see'st,
Here space and time are one.
Now give good heed and let me see,
If thou'rt a fool and pure,
What wisdom thou can'st presently secure.

The Knights of the Grail—

The holy supper daily prepare we day by day,
As on that last time truly, the soul it still may stay.
Who lives to do good deeds,
This meal for ever feeds ;
The cup his hand may lift,
And claim the purest gift.

Chorus—

As anguished and lowly.
His life stream's spilling for sinners
He did offer.
For the saviour holy,
I now with heart free and willing my blood will proffer.
His body given our sins to shrive,
Through death becomes in us alive.
His love endures, the dove up-soars,
The saviour's sacred token :
Take the wine red, for you it was shed,
Let bread of life be broken !

Alti and Tenori—

Take my body and eat,
Take and drink my blood.
Thus be our love remembered.

Soprani and Alti—

Take my body and eat,
Take and drink my blood,
Do this and think of me.

Titular—

Celestial rapture !
How light now the looks of the Lord !

Soprani and Alti—

Wine and Bread the Grail's Lord changed,
Which at that last meal was ranged,
Through his pity's loving tide,
When he shed for you his gore,
And his body crucified.
Blood and body which he offered,
Changed to food for you are proffered,
By the Saviour ye revere,
In the wine which now ye pour,
And the bread ye eat of here.

Tenori and Bassi—

Take of this bread, change it again,
Your powers of body firing,
Living and dead, strive might and main,
To work out the Lord's desiring.
Take of this wine, change it anew,
To life's impetuous torrent,
Gladly combine, brothers so true,
To fight as your duty shall warrant.

Chorus—

Blest in love and believing !
By pity lightened, the guileless fool.
Blessed believing !

RHAPSODIE

(Fragment aus Goethe's Harzreise im Winter),

FOR

Contralto Solo, Chorus of Men's Voices and Orchestra,

By JOHANNES BRAHMS.

Op. 53.

LIEDERTAFEL AND ORCHESTRA.

SOLOIST

MISS ADA CROSSLEY.

The deep majestic expression which the greatest musical classic of our time has given to the Words of Goethe, establishes the work under notice as one of the highest manifestations of lofty subjectivity and profound contemplation that we worship in art. The Solo voice is responsible for the text throughout. The entry of Tenors and Basses—each in two parts—is made at the words, "But if thy Psalter."

JOHANNES BRAHMS, born 1833 at Hamburg; as a boy excited great attention both by compositions and pianoforte playing. In 1874 he was made a member of the Academy of Arts at Berlin. Excepting opera, Brahms has cultivated nearly every branch of musical composition. Powerful, original and versatile, Brahms, more than any other, sums up in his strongly-marked individuality the varying elements, classical as well as romantic, of contemporaneous culture. His imagination, to which he at first allowed too free a scope (about to Op. 10), he has bridled by severe study and rigid self-criticism; and although reflection plays a large part in his compositions, he has produced abundance of music of a thoroughly spontaneous and inspired character. His melodies possess inexhaustible variety, ranging from naïve simplicity and a dreamy poetical tenderness peculiar to himself, to stirring pathos, striking force, and glowing passion; always remaining pregnant and concise. His harmony, often surprisingly bold and original, is subordinated to the dictates of a high artistic idea, which permeates and controls the formal construction of his works, in which an admirable mastery of contrapuntal art is often exhibited. His songs extend from the simplest specimens of popular melody to the richest and most complicated forms of art.

BUT who goes there apart? In the brake his pathway is lost,
Close behind clash the branches together, the grass rises again,
the desert engulphs him.
Who can comfort his anguish?
Who, if balsam be deathly,
If the hate of men from the fulness of love be drained?

He that was scorned turned to scorner, lonely now devours all he hath
of worth in a barren self-seeking.
But if from Thy Psalter all-loving Father one strain can but come to
his hearing,
Oh! enlighten his heart!
Lift up his o'er-clouded eyes where are the fountains hard by the thirsty
one in the desert.
But if from Thy Psalter, all-loving Father, one strain can but come to
his hearing,
Oh! enlighten his heart, enlighten his heart.

INTERVAL OF FIVE MINUTES.

CONCERTO (No. 1 in E flat)—

For Pianoforte & Orchestra

Franz Liszt

First performance in this City in its original form.

ALLEGRO MAESTOSO.

QUASI ADAGIO.

ALLEGRETTO VIVACE.

ALLEGRO MARZIALE ANIMATO.

SOLOIST - MISS DORA STAMP.

(A student of Mr. H. J. King.)

Her first appearance.

"LANDERKENNUNG"

(LAND SIGHTING)

For Baritone Solo, Chorus of Men's voices, Organ and Orchestra.

By EDWARD GRIEG.

Op. 31.

(First performance in this city.)

LIEDERTAFEL AND ORCHESTRA.

SOLOIST

- HERR R. NITSCHKE.

EDWARD GRIEG was born in 1843. His melodic inventiveness and original power of expression places him in the front rank of contemporaneous composers. The presentation of *Landerkenning* in Melbourne will doubtless be acceptable as a tribute to his genius.

AND it was Olav Trygvason,
Sailing on the north sea wide,
Bearing the hope to found a kingdom,
Far on the other side.
Yonder the cliffs appearing,
Like a battlement loom their dark crest rearing,
And it was Olav Trygvason,
Found he ne'er a spot to land.
E'en like the waves the royal desire,
Shattered upon the strand.
"See!" cried the bard upleaping.
Yonder snow covered peaks o'er cloud bands peeping.

And it was Olav Trygvason,
Suddenly he seemed to sight,
Towering temples, domes and spires,
Glist'ning in virgin white.
Then vow'd the king undaunted,
With his followers to tread that land enchanted,

Onward he went ; the rushing streams
Heralded the coming spring,
Swayed in the stormy wind, the forest strangely was murmuring
Sounds as of churchbells chiming.
And then spake the king,
Spake as tho' dreaming :
Here the spot to found our kingdom !
Hell ! these temple walls defy thee !
Hearts are swelling, souls are yearning,
God, to thee alone be glory.

Be my faith as yonder mountains,
Root as deeply, shine as purely ;
And as these my faith strive upwards,
On to him, the All Creator.
Olav's prayer be ours to utter,
As we near the throne of mercy.
Hearts are swelling, souls are yearning,
God, to thee alone be glory.
On to God ! On to God !

NOTE.—Those wishing to leave the hall before the conclusion of the performance will please avail themselves of this opportunity, as the doors will not be re-opened until the "Scheme" is completed

THE LEGEND OF ST. ELIZABETH

(OF HUNGARY).

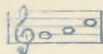
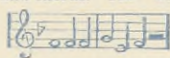
For Solo Voices, Chorus (S.A.T.B.) Organ & Orchestra,

BY

FRANZ LISZT.

S. ELIZABETH was specially composed by the Abbé Liszt at the instigation of the Grand Duke of Weimar for a Festival held at the Wartburg on the 28th of August, 1867, in commemoration of the eighth centenary of the founding and in honour of the restoration, then just completed, of that remarkable and

historically interesting relic of the middle ages. The legend of S. Elizabeth is a tolerably familiar one at least to Roman Catholics. In the "Crusader Scene" to be performed this afternoon, the action presumably laid a Schmalkald on the borders of Thuringia—for it was to this place that Landgrave Ludwig went with Elizabeth and their family to meet the knights and nobles who were to accompany him to the Holy Land, represents the courtyard of a mediæval castle, filled with troops on the point of departure and the friends who have come to bid them adieu. The troops, acknowledging Ludwig as their leader encourage each other in their resolve to fight for the Faith. Ludwig calls upon his assembled subjects to swear allegiance to him and to Elizabeth in his absence. After a sad but affectionate leave-taking of his wife and children, Ludwig places himself at the head of his troops, which now set out on their march to join the new crusade. The Gregorian "intonation" symbolical of the Cross, and as forming the key-note to its intent, appropriately forms the basis of the Crusaders' March and chorus. The "Trio" as it may be regarded, which occurs



twice in the Crusaders' March, is derived from an old pilgrims' song dating from the time of the Crusaders.



"The Crusaders' Scene."

ELIZABETH

M^{rs} ELISE WIEDERMANN.

LANDGRAVE LUDWIG HERR R. NITSCHKE.

ASSOCIATED LADIES' CHOIR, LIEDERTAFEL
ORGAN AND ORCHESTRA.

*Chorus of Crusaders—Recitative of Landgrave—Parting
of Landgrave and Elizabeth—Chorus and March of the
Crusaders.*

Chorus—

TO Palestine, the Holy Land,
Where the Redeemer's cross did stand,
Be thou our host's commander !
Come all by Christian zeal impelled
In holy war the sword to wield,
And be our faith's defender,
God wills it !

Ludwig—

Assembled are my faithful vassals,
At my command, ere my departure,
That they may swear to me allegiance
For comfort in the hour of parting,
The call divine, the holy cities
From pagan hordes idolatrous to ransom,
Upon my soul has ceaseless pressed :
And yet I am filled with sorrow,
To leave ye, ah, my loved ones, here alone,
Elizabeth !—Swear unto me
That you will guard her truly as your ruler,
And stand by her in weal and woe to serve her.

Chorus—

She is all goodness, she is all beauty,
We swear to her allegiance and duty ;
We stand by thee in weal and woe to serve,
We stand by thee to serve thee faithfully.

Ludwig—

Farewell, my wife !

Elizabeth—

Oh tarry !
O shorten not the hour,
The last sweet hour of gladness,
The last we pass together.
My inmost spirit tells me
That I in grief and pain
In vain shall wait the moment
That brings thee back again.
Ah ! must thou then forsake me ?

Ludwig—

'Twas thou, my love, who gav'st me
Those higher aspirations
Toward which my heart is yearning—
The thirst for self-devotion.

Elizabeth—

With grief my spirit wrestles,
But in my inmost soul
One only thought is borne me,
That I shall ceaseless mourn thee—
This only do I know.
Around my pathway evil
Spreads forth its wings with might,
No star of hope beams comfort
To guide me through the night.
I tremble, awed and fearful,
I wrestle, lone and tearful,
And fall beneath this crushing blow,
Seized by despair and woe!

Ludwig—

Where is thy courage, O my love,
Thine ardour, all thy holy trust?

Elizabeth—

Ah, let me weep upon thy breast!
See where thy children pleading stand,
In loving silence they implore thee,
As though their sad fate they foresaw.

Chorus of Crusaders—

To Palestine, the Holy Land!
God wills it!

Ludwig—

Hear'st thou the warning call? Farewell!
Farewell, for I must part from thee.

Chorus—

To Palestine, the Holy Land,
Be thou our host's commander!

Ludwig—

Farewell, my children, fare ye well,
May God's peace ever with you dwell!

Elizabeth—

Thou goest ? O God !

Ludwig—

In prayer remember me !
I must fulfil the mission I have chosen ;
Farewell, my wife, farewell !

Elizabeth—

He goes !
Alas, he goes ! I have forever lost him !

Chorus—

Come, all by Christian zeal impelled
In holy war the sword to wield,
And be our faith's defender !
God wills it !
To Palestine, the Holy Land,
Where the Redeemer's cross did stand,
Come, all by Christian zeal impelled
In holy war the sword to wield !
God wills it !

The thanks of the Society are due to Messrs. PATON & SONS (for the Plants), WEBB & SON (for the Vases FOY & GIBSON (for the Draperies), and NICHOLSON & CO. (for the Statuary).

*Ladies and Gentlemen wishing to join the
Society will please communicate with the
Hon. Sec., 59 Queen Street.*

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